Al-Amal for the Environment

Because the Climate Challenge is Everyone's Concern

Established in 1995, Al-Amal (Hope in Arabic) works within Israel's Arab minority and in joint Jewish-Arab dynamics to promote environmental protection and improvement, helping the community engage, campaign, and influence a wide range of issues. By developing local solutions, implementing sustainability initiatives, and driving action on climate change in the Galilee region, Al-Amal ensures everyone is involved and engaged in the fight for environmental protection.

Al-Amal empowers Arab and Jewish communities to work together on issues of mutual concern, thereby supporting Galilee's social integration. The organization has strong links at all levels, from the grassroots to the national, and is a trusted partner to municipalities, councils, and government agencies. Al-Amal has earned a strong reputation and is frequently featured in the media.

Our theory of change is twofold. First, by bringing Jews and Arabs in the Galilee together around shared interests, we contribute to the development of a vibrant, inclusive society. Second, by mentoring activist groups and regional agencies to advance climate action, we improve environmental conditions and help create a more sustainable future for our region.

While modest in size, Al-Amal has been supported over the years by the Jewish Federation of New York, the European Union, the Beracha and Yad Hanadiv Foundations, the U.S. Embassy, and others.

Programming

Galilee Mayors Forum

Established in 2022, Al-Amal's Galilee Mayors Forum brings together the leaders of 15 Arab municipalities across the Galilee to collaborate on climate change preparedness, waste management, and environmental planning. The forum serves as a collaborative think tank and a focal point for joint environmental advocacy. It is facilitated by Dr. Dov Khanin, Head of the Israeli Climate Forum; Prof. Rassem Khamaisi of the University of Haifa; and Dr. Orly Ronen of Tel Aviv University. The Forum works with government agencies to create, ratify, and secure funding and other support for environmental protection and development in the Galilee region. The overall annual cost of the Mayors' Forum is $52,000.

Arab-Jewish Citizens' Forums on Shared Environmental Concerns

Al-Amal's Citizens' Forums focus on shared spaces and shared society through the planning and development of these spaces. They plan, develop, and execute joint environmental projects, such as removing environmental hazards, creating shared walkways and public spaces, and engaging

local communities on environmental issues. Currently, three such forums are operating in Beit HaKerem, the Hilazon Valley, and Jdeide-Makr-Tal'el. Each Forum includes at least 30 citizens and has achieved significant successes, rejuvenating the Hilazon River and creating green neighborhoods and community gardens. Al-Amal uses the Forums to build community connections around shared issues and to train activists in lobbying, public protest, approaches to different stakeholder groups, and engagement with planning processes. By focusing on shared local concerns, the Forums empower Jewish and Arab volunteers to work together, strengthen their relationships, and foster dialogue, understanding, and collaboration.

'Local Impact' – Working with Local Authorities and Businesses

In 2021, Al-Amal received a three-year EU grant, together with Zalul, The Natural Step, and 2B Friendly, to promote environmentally responsible practices among local authorities and businesses. The project focused on reducing carbon footprints, improving energy efficiency, minimizing waste, and awarding a 'Green Label' to organizations meeting environmental standards. Al-Amal continues to support partners in reducing their environmental impact.

Towards 2026:

A. **Youth groups:** Budget permitting, we plan to broaden the scope of our Jewish-Arab work by establishing joint youth groups focused on the environment. High schools and municipal education departments have expressed interest, particularly in seeking new approaches to building a shared society after the war in Gaza. The overall annual cost of this plan is $55,000.

B. **Women's Local Environmental Improvement Committees**

Across the Galilee, Al-Amal is home to around 50 women activists, bringing together Arab and Jewish women to study and implement local environmental improvements. We aim to professionalize and formalize these groups so that women engage in activities focused on planning and developing their local village environments, such as reducing environmental hazards, reclaiming derelict spaces as communal gardens, creating "Green Neighborhoods," and running public awareness campaigns. Al-Amal offers women a valuable opportunity to take responsibility and work together to address their communities' needs. Participants gain a sense of empowerment and local pride, as well as social standing within their communities. The overall annual cost of this program is $38,000.

The environment belongs to everyone.
Join Al-Amal in empowering Israel's citizens to engage as equals in its preservation.

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